

CLASS 10 · ICSE · SELINA CONCISE MATHEMATICS · PYQ SOLUTIONS

Chapter 8: Remainder and Factor Theorems

Step-by-step solutions to the previous year questions

The question numbers match the PYQ question sheet.

1 The factor theorem

1. Which factor is common to $x^2 - 4$ and $x^3 - x^2 - 4x + 4$? (a) $(x + 1)$ (b) $(x - 1)$ (c) $(x - 2)$ (d) $(x - 4)$ **ICSE 2025, 1 mark**

SOLUTION

$$x^2 - 4 = (x - 2)(x + 2)$$

$$x^3 - x^2 - 4x + 4 = x^2(x - 1) - 4(x - 1) = (x - 1)(x - 2)(x + 2)$$

Of the options, $(x - 2)$ divides both.

Answer: (c)

2 Factorising a cubic polynomial

2. $(x - 2)$ is a factor of $2x^3 - 7x^2 + kx - 2$. Find k , and then factorise the polynomial completely. **ICSE 2025, 3 marks**

SOLUTION

By the factor theorem $f(2) = 0$: $16 - 28 + 2k - 2 = 0$, so $k = 7$.

Divide $2x^3 - 7x^2 + 7x - 2$ by $(x - 2)$: the quotient is $2x^2 - 3x + 1$.

$$2x^2 - 3x + 1 = (2x - 1)(x - 1)$$

Answer: $k = 7$; $2x^3 - 7x^2 + 7x - 2 = (x - 2)(2x - 1)(x - 1)$

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